Music & Sound

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Folk & roots

Appalachian old-time Appalachian old-time folk: fiddle and clawhammer banjo in unison, modal melody, a plain unvarnished voice, recorded close and dry on a porch

Bluegrass traditional bluegrass: fast three-finger banjo rolls, mandolin chop on the offbeat, fiddle and dobro breaks, upright bass, high lonesome three-part harmony, no drums

Americana Americana: strummed acoustic guitar and organ over a loose backbeat, pedal steel swells, a weathered storytelling vocal, warm analog production

Cosmic Americana cosmic Americana: country songwriting drenched in reverb, tremolo electric guitar and pedal steel swells, distant layered harmonies, a wide-open night-sky feeling

Alt-country alt-country: country instrumentation played with indie-rock looseness, jangly slightly distorted electric guitar, pedal steel, a ragged honest vocal

Cowboy ballad classic cowboy ballad: loping clip-clop rhythm, Spanish-tinged nylon guitar, a smooth baritone telling a tragic story of the old West, harmony "ooh"s behind

Spaghetti western score spaghetti western score: twangy reverb-soaked electric guitar, a lonely whistled melody, mariachi trumpet, wordless choir and galloping rhythm, sun-bleached drama

Outlaw country outlaw country: stripped-down band, twangy Telecaster, steady train-beat drums, a gruff unpolished baritone, 1970s Texas grit

Honky-tonk honky-tonk country: two-step shuffle, crying pedal steel, fiddle fills, a tinny barroom piano and a twangy heartbroken vocal

Murder ballad southern gothic murder ballad: sparse fingerpicked guitar and droning banjo in a minor mode, a hushed haunted vocal, a slow story that ends badly

Laurel Canyon folk-rock Laurel Canyon folk-rock: jangly 12-string guitars, piano, stacked three-part harmonies, sunny but bittersweet, warm 1970s analog production

Indie folk indie folk: fingerpicked acoustic guitar in a reverberant room, soaring layered harmonies, stomps and handclaps in the chorus, earnest and wistful

Chamber folk chamber folk: intimate acoustic guitar and a delicate string quartet arrangement, harp and woodwinds, a quiet literate vocal

Psych folk psychedelic folk: droning acoustic textures, hand percussion and recorder, a wavering otherworldly vocal, pastoral and slightly uncanny

Gospel & spirituals gospel: Hammond organ and piano, handclaps on two and four, a powerful lead vocal answered by a full choir, building to a joyful shout

Delta blues raw Delta blues: solo slide guitar on a resonator, a foot-stomp rhythm, a moaning untrained voice, scratchy 1930s recording

Celtic folk Celtic folk: fiddle and tin whistle playing a lively jig in 6/8, bodhrán frame drum, bouzouki rhythm, ornamented melody

Sea shanty sea shanty: a lead singer calls each line and a rough chorus of voices answers, foot stomps and concertina, bold and rhythmic

Cajun & zydeco Cajun two-step: diatonic accordion and fiddle in unison, scraped rubboard and triangle, hollered vocals in Louisiana French

Roots reggae roots reggae: one-drop drums, offbeat guitar skank, deep melodic bass, organ bubble, laid-back and warm

Afrobeat Afrobeat: interlocking funky guitars, polyrhythmic drums and percussion, a big horn section riffing, long hypnotic groove

Flamenco flamenco: rasgueado guitar strums, palmas handclaps and cajón, Phrygian melodies, raw impassioned singing

Fado fado: twelve-string Portuguese guitar and classical guitar, a mournful dramatic vocal full of longing, slow and intimate

Mariachi mariachi: bright trumpets and violins in harmony, strummed vihuela and guitarrón bass, a proud soaring vocal with gritos

Cumbia cumbia: steady scraped güiro, loping bass, accordion or organ melody, a swaying dance groove

Klezmer klezmer: wailing clarinet with bends and sobs, violin and accordion, oom-pah tuba, a freylekhs dance rhythm in the freygish mode

Gamelan Balinese gamelan: shimmering interlocking bronze metallophones with beating tuning, gong cycles, kendang drums

Genres

Surf rock surf rock: twangy Fender guitar drenched in spring reverb, rapid tremolo picking, driving drums, instrumental

Rockabilly rockabilly: slapped upright bass, twangy hollow-body guitar, slapback echo on a hiccuping vocal, Sun Studio 1956

Garage rock garage rock: fuzzed-out guitars, cheap combo organ, crashing drums, a raw shouted vocal, recorded loud and fast

Psychedelic rock psychedelic rock: phased guitars, swirling organ, backwards tape effects, dreamy vocals, hazy 1967 production

Heartland rock heartland rock: chiming guitars, Hammond organ and piano, driving straight eighths, a raspy anthemic vocal about small towns and open roads

Desert noir desert noir: slow baritone twang guitar with deep tremolo and reverb, distant mariachi trumpet, brushed drums, a low cinematic vocal

Desert rock desert rock: down-tuned fuzz riffs, hypnotic repetition, heat-haze guitar tone, hazy vocals floating on top

Dream pop dream pop: shimmering chorused guitars, soft synth pads, a breathy reverb-soaked vocal, slow and hazy

Shoegaze shoegaze: a wall of distorted pitch-bending guitars, vocals buried in the mix, washes of reverb, loud and blurry

Post-rock post-rock: instrumental, a long crescendo from quiet tremolo-picked guitars to a cathartic wall of sound, cinematic

Post-punk post-punk: driving melodic bass up front, angular chorused guitar, mechanical drums, a cold baritone vocal

Indie rock indie rock: jangly interlocking guitars, tight bright drums, a casual earnest vocal, 2000s indie production

Grunge grunge: quiet clean verses that explode into sludgy distorted choruses, anguished vocals, raw early-90s production

Krautrock krautrock: hypnotic motorik beat, repetitive bass, droning analog synths, long and forward-driving

Doo-wop 1950s doo-wop: a vocal group with a falsetto lead and a bass voice singing nonsense syllables, triplet piano, I–vi–IV–V changes

Wall of Sound pop 1960s girl-group pop with a Wall of Sound: layered pianos and guitars, castanets, strings and timpani, huge echo-chamber reverb

Motown soul Motown soul: four-on-the-floor tambourine and snare, a busy melodic bass line, horn stabs, call-and-response backing vocals, bright 1965 mix

Southern soul Southern soul: a tight rhythm section, Hammond organ, punchy horn section, a raw pleading vocal, warm 1968 analog recording

Disco disco: four-on-the-floor kick, open hi-hats on the offbeat, octave-jumping bass, lush string sweeps, chicken-scratch guitar

Synth-pop 80s synth-pop: analog synth arpeggios, drum machine with a gated-reverb snare, glossy pads, a cool emotive vocal

City pop Japanese city pop: slap bass, Rhodes electric piano, bright brass, glossy late-70s production, a breezy nighttime-city mood

Yacht rock yacht rock: smooth jazzy chords on Rhodes, clean session guitar, saxophone solo, a soft blue-eyed soul vocal, polished late-70s LA production

80s power ballad 80s power ballad: soft piano opening, explosive drums and distorted guitars in the chorus, a belted climactic key change, huge reverb

Bedroom pop bedroom pop: lo-fi home recording, soft clean guitar and cheap synths, a quiet intimate double-tracked vocal

Neo-soul neo-soul: warm Rhodes chords, drums laid way behind the beat, round bass, a jazzy relaxed vocal

Baroque pop baroque pop: harpsichord and string quartet, French horn, lush layered harmonies, melancholy and ornate

Modern R&B modern R&B: deep sub bass and crisp 808s, airy synth pads, silky stacked vocals and ad-libs, intimate and spacious

Ambient ambient: beatless, slowly evolving pads and drones, sparse piano notes, long reverb tails, calm and spacious

Synthwave synthwave: pulsing analog synth arpeggios, gated-reverb snare, neon saw leads, retro 1980s night-drive mood

House deep house: four-on-the-floor kick, offbeat open hi-hats, warm chord stabs, rolling bassline, 122 BPM

Techno techno: relentless four-on-the-floor kick, hypnotic 909 hi-hats, a repetitive modular synth line, dark warehouse atmosphere, 132 BPM

Drum and bass drum and bass: rapid chopped breakbeats at 174 BPM, deep rolling sub bass, atmospheric pads

Trip-hop trip-hop: a slow dusty breakbeat, deep bass, cinematic sampled strings, vinyl crackle, a smoky melancholy vocal

Lo-fi hip-hop lo-fi hip-hop: lazy swung boom-bap drums, jazzy Rhodes chords, vinyl crackle and tape wobble, a mellow study mood, 80 BPM

Boom bap boom-bap hip-hop: hard-hitting sampled kick and snare, a chopped soul loop, scratched hook, 90 BPM, golden-era New York

Trap trap: booming 808 bass slides, fast rolling hi-hat triplets, half-time snare, a dark minor-key melody, 140 BPM

Dub roots dub: deep bass up front, one-drop drums, offbeat skank thrown into tape echo and spring reverb, instruments dropping in and out

Chillwave chillwave: hazy filtered synths, washed-out drum machine, nostalgic summer mood, lo-fi warmth

Vaporwave vaporwave: slowed-down 1980s smooth-jazz and mall-muzak samples, chopped loops, heavy reverb, eerie nostalgia

Folktronica folktronica: plucked acoustic and found-sound samples cut into glitchy electronic beats, warm and organic

Big band swing big-band swing: brass and sax sections trading riffs, walking bass, a swinging ride cymbal, 1940s ballroom

Bebop bebop: fast virtuosic sax and trumpet lines, complex chord changes, walking bass and a busy ride cymbal

Cool & modal jazz cool modal jazz: muted trumpet, relaxed tenor sax, brushed drums, spacious piano voicings, late-night 1959

Film noir jazz film noir jazz: a slow smoky tenor saxophone, brushed drums, upright bass, vibraphone, a rain-slick city at night

Bossa nova bossa nova: gentle syncopated nylon-string guitar, soft brushed percussion, light flute, a near-whispered vocal

Minimalism minimalist composition: interlocking repeating piano and marimba patterns that shift gradually, a hypnotic steady pulse

Romantic orchestral lush Romantic-era orchestral: sweeping strings, warm French horns, expressive rubato, big emotional swells

Impressionist impressionist: shimmering piano and harp, whole-tone and pentatonic colors, blurred pedal, a watercolor mood

Baroque baroque: harpsichord continuo, a crisp string ensemble, interlocking counterpoint, steady motor rhythm

Sacred choral sacred choral: an a cappella choir with pure straight tone, slow suspensions, cathedral reverb

Epic trailer epic trailer music: low brass braams, pounding taiko, a staccato string ostinato, a rising choir, huge hybrid orchestral climax

Western film score classic Hollywood Western score: soaring open-fifth brass themes, galloping strings and snare, wide-open Americana orchestration

Horror score horror score: dissonant string clusters, low drones, sudden stingers, unsettling prepared piano, creeping dread

Chiptune chiptune: 8-bit square-wave lead, triangle-wave bass, noise-channel drums, upbeat NES game soundtrack

Instruments

Strummed acoustic guitar a strummed steel-string acoustic guitar driving the rhythm

Fingerpicked guitar gently fingerpicked acoustic guitar, an alternating thumb bass under a picked melody

12-string guitar a chiming 12-string guitar with natural octave shimmer

Nylon-string guitar a warm nylon-string guitar, soft and round

Clawhammer banjo clawhammer banjo with a percussive bum-ditty rhythm and a ringing high drone string

Three-finger banjo fast bright three-finger bluegrass banjo rolls

Fiddle a fiddle with slides and double stops, bowing a lonesome melody

Mandolin bright mandolin, tremolo-picked on the held notes

Upright bass a woody upright bass playing a walking line

Dobro a nasal singing dobro, slid with a steel bar

Pedal steel pedal steel swelling and crying behind the vocal

Autoharp a shimmering strummed autoharp

Appalachian dulcimer a gentle Appalachian dulcimer playing a modal melody over its own drone

Hammered dulcimer a ringing hammered dulcimer with sustained sparkling notes

Harmonica a wailing harmonica with bent notes between verses

Accordion a wheezy nostalgic accordion

Washboard & spoons scratchy washboard and spoons percussion

Telecaster twang a bright twangy Telecaster with slapback echo

Tremolo baritone guitar a low twangy baritone electric guitar through pulsing amp tremolo and deep spring reverb

Fuzz guitar a buzzy woolly fuzz guitar riff

Jangle guitar bright jangly clean electric guitar arpeggios with a touch of chorus

Rhodes electric piano warm bell-like Rhodes electric piano chords

Wurlitzer a reedy Wurlitzer electric piano with gentle tremolo

Hammond organ a Hammond B3 organ through a swirling Leslie speaker

Honky-tonk piano a jangly out-of-tune honky-tonk upright piano

Grand piano an intimate close-miked felt piano with soft hammers and audible pedal noise

Mellotron wobbly vintage Mellotron flutes

Analog synth bass a fat squelchy analog synth bass

Synth pad a warm slow-attack analog synth pad holding chords underneath

Brushed drums soft brushed drums with gentle swishes on the snare

Floor toms rolling thunderous floor toms instead of a snare backbeat

TR-808 booming 808 kick and bass with ticking hi-hats

String section a lush string section swelling under the chorus

Solo cello a solo cello singing a slow, mournful line

Harp a harp glissando opening into gentle arpeggios

French horn warm French horns playing a noble open-fifth theme

Muted trumpet a lonesome muted trumpet in the distance

Tenor saxophone a breathy smoky tenor saxophone

Clarinet a woody clarinet line with a playful lilt

Flute & whistle an airy breathy flute melody

Timpani a timpani roll swelling into a booming hit

Celesta & glockenspiel a twinkling celesta melody like a music box

Harmonium a wheezy drone of harmonium chords

Pipe organ a massive cathedral pipe organ

Whistling a lonely whistled melody carrying across open space

Musical saw a wavering ghostly musical saw

Theremin a gliding vibrato-heavy theremin

Music box a delicate wind-up music box melody

Toy piano a plinky out-of-tune toy piano

Vibraphone mellow vibraphone with a slow pulsing tremolo

Kalimba a soft bell-like kalimba pattern

Church bells distant church bells tolling

Stomps & claps foot stomps on a wooden floor and handclaps on the backbeat

Tambourine & shaker a tambourine shaking on every beat

Choir "oohs" wordless choir "oohs" swelling behind the chorus

Rhythm & tempo

Very slow a very slow tempo, around 55 BPM, every beat given room

Ballad tempo a slow ballad tempo, around 70 BPM

Walking pace an unhurried walking tempo, around 88 BPM

Mid-tempo a steady mid-tempo groove, around 110 BPM

Dance tempo a danceable tempo, 124 BPM

Uptempo a driving uptempo beat, around 150 BPM

Breakneck a breakneck tempo, around 180 BPM

4/4 common time in 4/4 time

3/4 waltz a swaying 3/4 waltz rhythm

6/8 a rolling 6/8 rhythm

12/8 slow blues a heavy 12/8 slow-blues triplet feel

2/4 two-beat a bouncing two-beat feel, bass on one and chord on two

5/4 an off-kilter 5/4 rhythm felt as 3+2

7/8 a lurching 7/8 groove grouped 2+2+3

Free time performed in free time, rubato, no steady beat

Straight eighths a straight-eighths rock beat, kick on one and three, snare on two and four

Swing swung eighth notes, a lilting jazz swing feel on the ride cymbal

Shuffle a bouncing blues shuffle with a boogie bass line

Train beat a chugging country train beat on the snare

Boom-chick an alternating boom-chick guitar pattern, bass note then strum

Texas two-step a brisk Texas two-step shuffle for the dance floor

Four on the floor a four-on-the-floor kick on every beat

Half-time a heavy half-time feel with the snare on three

Motorik a steady unbroken motorik beat that never fills

Bo Diddley beat a Bo Diddley beat on tom-toms and maracas

Gallop a galloping long-short-short rhythm like hooves

Stomp-clap a communal stomp-clap beat, stomps on every beat and claps on two and four

Bossa nova groove a gentle bossa nova groove with a syncopated rim click

One drop a reggae one-drop beat, kick and rim together on three

Son clave a 3-2 son clave pattern on wood block

Breakbeat a syncopated funk breakbeat with ghost notes on the snare

Behind the beat drums sitting lazily behind the beat, a relaxed deep pocket

Harmony & melody

Major in a bright major key

Natural minor in a melancholy minor key

Dorian in Dorian mode, minor but with a hopeful raised sixth

Mixolydian in Mixolydian mode, major with a bluesy flat seventh

Phrygian in Phrygian mode with a dark Spanish flat second

Lydian in Lydian mode, dreamy and floating with a raised fourth

Harmonic minor in harmonic minor, dark and exotic

Major pentatonic a simple major pentatonic melody, open and folk-like

Minor pentatonic riffs built on the minor pentatonic scale

Blues scale bluesy melodies with bent blue notes

I–IV–V a simple I–IV–V three-chord progression

I–V–vi–IV an uplifting I–V–vi–IV pop progression

I–vi–IV–V nostalgic 1950s I–vi–IV–V changes

ii–V–I jazzy ii–V–I changes with seventh chords

12-bar blues a 12-bar blues progression with dominant sevenths

Andalusian cadence a dramatic descending Andalusian cadence, i–♭VII–♭VI–V

i–♭VI–♭III–♭VII a yearning cinematic minor loop, i–♭VI–♭III–♭VII

I–♭VII–IV a swaggering I–♭VII–IV vamp

Plagal cadence ends on a warm IV–I "amen" cadence

Circle of fifths jaunty old-timey ragtime changes moving around the circle of fifths

vi–IV–I–V a wistful vi–IV–I–V progression

I–III–IV–iv a bittersweet I–III–IV–iv progression ending on the aching minor four

Suspended chords open suspended chords that hang unresolved

Major seventh dreamy major-seventh chords

Extended jazz chords lush extended chords, minor ninths and thirteenths

Minor four a heartbreaking turn to the minor four chord

Drone & pedal tone melodies moving over a constant low drone

Truck-driver key change a key change up a whole step into the final chorus

Open tunings acoustic guitar in an open tuning, ringing drone strings

Hook a short, instantly memorable hook repeated in the chorus

Riff built on a repeating low guitar riff

Ostinato a persistent string ostinato that builds tension

Arpeggio gently arpeggiated chords

Countermelody a countermelody on strings weaving around the vocal

Harmony in thirds melody doubled in sweet parallel thirds

Unison & octaves fiddle and banjo playing the tune in unison

Call and response call and response between the lead and the band

Song structure

Intro a short instrumental intro that sets the mood before the vocal enters

Verse verses that tell the story in a lower, conversational register

Pre-chorus a pre-chorus that climbs and builds tension into the chorus

Chorus a big, singable chorus that repeats the title

Post-chorus a chanted wordless post-chorus right after each chorus

Bridge a contrasting bridge with new chords before the final chorus

Instrumental break an instrumental break where the pedal steel takes a solo

Breakdown a breakdown where everything drops out except voice and one guitar

Build & drop a build-up with a snare roll and rising filter, then a drop into the full beat

Outro an outro that returns to the opening guitar and slows to a stop

Verse–chorus classic verse–chorus form with a bridge before the last chorus

AABA 32-bar AABA form: main melody twice, a contrasting bridge, then the main melody again

Strophic ballad a strophic folk ballad: many verses on one melody, no chorus, each verse ending on a short refrain line

12-bar blues form twelve-bar blues verses with an AAB lyric: a line sung twice, then answered

Through-composed through-composed: a sequence of distinct sections with no repeating chorus

Loop-based built on a single repeating loop, with sections made by adding and removing layers

Cold open starts cold on the vocal with no intro

Fade-out ends on a repeating chorus that slowly fades out

Cold ending ends abruptly with the whole band stopping on one hit

False ending a false ending: silence for two bars, then the band crashes back in for one last chorus

A cappella break the band drops out for an a cappella chorus, then slams back in

Spoken-word section a quiet spoken-word section over a soft instrumental bed

Quiet–loud dynamics hushed whispered verses that explode into loud choruses

Tag ending ends by repeating the final chorus line three times, slowing on the last

Final chorus lift the final chorus lifts with a full choir and double-time drums

Vocals

Breathy a soft breathy vocal close to the mic

Deep baritone a deep resonant baritone

Falsetto & head voice a fragile soaring falsetto

Raspy & gravelly a raspy gravelly worn-in voice

Country twang a bright twangy country vocal with Southern vowels

Pure & clear a pure clear bell-like vocal with little vibrato

Smoky contralto a smoky velvety contralto

Belting a powerful belted vocal on the final chorus

High lonesome a piercing high lonesome bluegrass tenor

Yodel a cowboy yodel flipping between chest voice and falsetto

Melisma soulful melismatic runs on the held words

Straight tone held notes sung with a still straight tone and no vibrato

Wide vibrato a dramatic wide vibrato on held notes

Talk-singing a half-spoken talk-sung delivery, loose and conversational

Whispered a hushed, nearly whispered vocal

Scat playful improvised jazz scat singing

Sibling harmony two closely matched voices singing in tight sibling harmony

Three-part harmony rich stacked three-part harmonies on the chorus

Gang vocals ragged gang vocals shouting the chorus together

Lead and choir a lead singer answered by a full gospel choir

Duet a duet: two voices trade verses and join in harmony on the chorus

Wordless vocals a soaring wordless vocal used like an instrument

Distant & reverb-drenched a vocal placed far back in a cavernous reverb, as if sung across a lake

Double-tracked a double-tracked vocal, two takes stacked

Slapback vocal a vocal with 1950s slapback echo

Old-radio vocal a lo-fi vocal filtered like an old AM radio

Hard Auto-Tune a vocal with hard robotic Auto-Tune

Vocoder a robotic vocoder voice

Chopped vocal samples chopped and re-pitched vocal samples played as a melody

Production & mix

1920s–30s shellac sounds like a scratchy 1920s 78 rpm record: narrow, honky midrange, surface crackle and hiss

1950s mono 1950s mono recording: live band around a few tube mics, slapback echo, warm and punchy

1960s studio 1960s studio sound: four-track tape, echo-chamber reverb, bright midrange, slightly lo-fi drums

1970s analog warm 1970s analog production: dry close-miked drums, saturated tape, intimate and rich

1980s digital glossy 1980s production: gated-reverb snare, chorused guitars, bright digital reverb

Home 4-track lo-fi home 4-track cassette recording: tape hiss, slight wobble, intimate and unpolished

Live in one room recorded live off the floor in one room, natural room sound and bleed between mics

Modern polished modern polished production: tight, wide, bright and loud

Field recording a field recording on a porch at night: crickets and room noise in the background

Dry & close bone-dry and close, no reverb

Room reverb a short natural room reverb

Plate reverb a bright smooth plate reverb on the vocal

Spring reverb drippy spring reverb on the guitar

Hall reverb a lush concert-hall reverb

Cathedral an enormous cathedral reverb where every note hangs for seconds

Slapback echo a single short slapback echo

Tape echo warm wobbly tape echo repeats trailing off into the distance

Ping-pong delay echoes bouncing left and right in a ping-pong delay

Gated reverb a huge 1980s gated-reverb snare

Chorus shimmering chorus on the clean guitar

Flanger a sweeping jet-plane flanger

Phaser a slow swirling phaser

Tremolo throbbing amp tremolo pulsing in time

Rotary speaker swirling rotary-speaker effect

Wow & flutter warped wobbly tape with wow and flutter

Tape saturation warm tape saturation gluing the mix together

Overdrive a crunchy overdriven amp

Fuzz thick buzzing fuzz distortion

Bitcrush crunchy bitcrushed digital texture

Wide stereo a wide spacious stereo mix

Mono mixed in punchy vintage mono

Vocal up front the vocal mixed loud and up front, every word clear

Buried vocal the vocal buried low in the mix, words half-heard

Music from the next room muffled as if heard from the next room

Telephone EQ narrow telephone-style EQ on the intro

Vinyl crackle warm vinyl crackle underneath

Sidechain pump pads pumping with sidechain compression on every kick

Punchy low end a tight punchy low end that hits hard

Sound design

Wind in the pines soft wind rushing through pines, gusts rising and falling

Lake at night water lapping against a wooden dock at night, a distant loon

Summer night crickets chirping on a warm summer night

Rain & distant thunder steady rain on a tin roof with thunder rolling in the distance

Campfire a crackling campfire close by

Ocean waves slow ocean waves rolling in and drawing back

Loon call the haunting wail of a loon echoing across a still lake

Distant train a freight train horn in the distance and wheels clacking on the rails

Radio between stations AM radio static as the dial turns, then a faint old song comes through

Room tone quiet room tone with a faint electrical hum

Riser a white-noise riser building tension into the drop

Sub drop a deep sub drop on the downbeat

Impact a huge cinematic impact with a long reverb tail

Whoosh a fast whoosh passing from left to right

Stinger a sharp orchestral stinger on the reveal

Reverse swell a reverse swell sucking into the downbeat

Drone a low dark drone slowly shifting underneath

Shepard tone an endlessly rising Shepard tone

Glitch stuttering glitchy edits and buffer repeats

Heartbeat a low heartbeat pulse under the silence

Sine wave a pure soft sine tone

Square wave a hollow buzzy square-wave lead

Sawtooth wave a bright buzzing sawtooth synth

White, pink & brown noise filtered noise like a distant roar

FM bell glassy FM synth bells

Granular texture a shimmering granular cloud made from plucked guitar

Supersaw pad a huge shimmering detuned supersaw pad

Warm a warm rounded tone with soft highs

Bright a bright crisp sparkling tone

Dark a dark muted tone with no top end

Airy an airy open top end with breath and shimmer

Gritty a gritty raw tone with dirt left in

Glassy glassy crystalline tones

Hollow a hollow boxy tone

Metallic a metallic ringing clang

Lush lush layered chorus and reverb filling the space

Thin a thin tinny tone with no low end